

Hackles Mentors • School-Partner Agreement and Risk Checklists

The Hackles Kit

A free kit by Competence Collective · competencecollective.org · quillsup.org · October 2026

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FIELD NOTE

No. 1

Status: DRAFT. These checklists organize the conversation. They are not a contract. Counsel drafts the agreement, and risk management or the insurer decides the coverage questions. [COUNSEL/HR TO CONFIRM]

Part A. School-partner agreement checklist

A WRITTEN AGREEMENT IS signed for each host school or library before any mentor visits. A new agreement or an addendum is needed whenever the terms change.

A1. PARTIES AND PURPOSE

- ☐ Names of the college and the school or library, the signers and their authority [COUNSEL TO CONFIRM]
- ☐ Purpose: Hackles Day or classroom visits as invited by the host
- ☐ Term, renewal and either party's right to end the arrangement at once for safety
- ☐ The host's teacher leads; mentors support

A2. SAFEGUARDING AND SUPERVISION

- ☐ Host staff present at all times; no mentor alone with a child
- ☐ Ratios and room layout agreed (see charter, Section 6)
- ☐ Host's visitor sign-in and badge process

- ☐ Host's screening or fingerprinting rules for visitors and how mentors meet them [VERIFY]
- ☐ Host's safeguarding contact, disclosure protocol and reporting procedure, shared with the college in writing
- ☐ Mentors' mandated-reporter status under state law [VERIFY state law] and the handoff procedure to the staff member present
- ☐ Who files any required report, and how the college is told afterward
- ☐ Host's rules for restrooms, medical needs, allergies, behavior and emergencies
- ☐ Host's policy on photos, recordings and social media (mentors take none)
- ☐ Opt-outs and accommodations for children, handled by the host

A3. CONTENT

- ☐ Hackles lesson text and approved station materials only
- ☐ The host's teacher approves anything extra
- ☐ No sensitive topics run by mentors (sextortion, grooming, body safety are led by trained staff or the teacher)
- ☐ No live hacking, no demonstrations on real accounts, no scary stories
- ☐ No marketing to children: no products, employers, QR codes or stickers

A4. DATA AND PRIVACY

- ☐ No student data collected by the college or mentors, ever
- ☐ Aggregate counts only for the impact tracker (class numbers, grade band, number of stations)
- ☐ No names of children or schools in public materials without written approval
- ☐ FERPA and the host's privacy policies respected [COUNSEL TO CONFIRM]

A5. RESPONSIBILITIES AND RISK

- ☐ Each party's insurance (see Part B) and certificate exchange
- ☐ Indemnification, hold-harmless and limits, as counsel drafts [COUNSEL TO CONFIRM]
- ☐ Who handles injuries and incidents, and the notification timeline
- ☐ Mentors' status (volunteers, student workers or service-learning participants) stated [COUNSEL/HR TO CONFIRM]
- ☐ Governing law and dispute resolution [COUNSEL]

A6. LOGISTICS

- ☐ Dates, times, room, accessible routes and parking
- ☐ Number of children, grade bands and number of adults
- ☐ Emergency plan: exits, lockdown, severe weather, who calls whom
- ☐ Emergency contacts for the school and the college for the day
- ☐ Cancellation process, including weather

A7. AFTER THE VISIT

- ☐ Thank-you note to the school
- ☐ A short feedback form for the teacher (no student data)
- ☐ Debrief with mentors
- ☐ Any incident reports filed and closed

Part B. Transportation and insurance checklist

[COUNSEL/RISK MANAGEMENT TO CONFIRM every item. Rules for volunteer driving, field trips and coverage vary by college, state and insurer.]

B1. TRANSPORTATION

- ☐ Prefer events that mentors can reach on their own: on campus, or at a school accessible by public transit.
- ☐ Mentors travel on their own. They do not transport children.
- ☐ If the college provides transport for mentors: use a college vehicle or a chartered service operated by a licensed driver, and follow the college's vehicle policy and driver screening [COUNSEL/RISK MANAGEMENT TO CONFIRM].
- ☐ Mentors who drive their own car for the college do so under the college's policy on personal vehicle use and with their own current license and insurance [COUNSEL/RISK TO CONFIRM], with no passengers other than other mentors if the college allows it.
- ☐ No mentor drives a child, even when asked by a parent or teacher.
- ☐ Mileage or transit support, if offered, is stated in advance [LOCAL budget].
- ☐ Event location, return time and a check-in text to the coordinator after arrival.

B2. CHILDREN VISITING CAMPUS

- ☐ The school provides transport, supervision and parental permission slips.
- ☐ A campus walk-through for safety, accessible routes, restrooms and an emergency plan.
- ☐ College visitor, signage and parking arrangements.
- ☐ Campus police informed of the visit [LOCAL].

B3. INSURANCE QUESTIONS FOR RISK MANAGEMENT

- ☐ Does the college's general liability policy cover the program and its volunteers?
- ☐ Is there coverage for abuse and molestation claims, and for any sublimits? [VERIFY]
- ☐ Is workers' compensation or student accident coverage available for volunteers and student workers?
- ☐ Does the school's policy require the college to be named as an additional insured or the school to be named on the college's policy?
- ☐ Certificates of insurance exchanged with each host
- ☐ Is there coverage for the use of personal cars on college business?
- ☐ Is there cyber liability or privacy coverage? (The program collects no student data, which should keep this risk low.)
- ☐ Does the college's state-law immunity or volunteer-protection statute apply? [COUNSEL TO CONFIRM; VERIFY state law]

B4. EVENT-DAY SAFETY

- ☐ First-aid kit and an adult trained in first aid [LOCAL]
- ☐ Allergy awareness through the school, with no food provided by mentors unless the host approves
- ☐ Emergency exits, assembly point and communication plan
- ☐ Weather plan for outdoor stations
- ☐ Incident forms (Document 06) printed and with the coordinator

Hackles has not been evaluated in a controlled study. This checklist does not replace the advice of counsel, risk management or an insurer.